



BRC's Safety Guidelines Book
Late & Missing Persons Guidelines

Scope:

All BCMG events & hirers

Content

The Bogong Rover Chalet has:

- Land Line Phone
- Mobile coverage within 200m (Limited coverage in Chalet)
- UHF Radio
- Longer range radio coverage from Tow Hut (due to repeater access)
- A no alcohol policy while Tour Parties are out.
- PLB's for touring party use

All Tour Parties will have followed the guidelines before setting out on tour:

- Complete Trip Intentions form
- Sought Approval from Party Leader or Approved Person
- Groups of no less than 4.
- Be carrying the necessary equipment for the tour (detailed on Trip Intentions form)
- Tour Leaders have Nobs, Chalet, Wardens and Tour Members phone numbers (from Trip Intention form)
- Tour Members have the Chalet and Tour Leaders phone number
- Tour Party members have means for communication and stating their location (Radio (opt), Mobile Phone, GPS, Emergency Plus app, Mapping app)
- Tour Members should have their Phones notifications set to Loud

Deviations from Trip Intention can occur, where possible these need to be notified to the Chalet (or Nobs). Changes need to be recorded on original Trip Intentions Form. If they cannot be notified – the party should consider whether they should proceed with the altered route (unless it is a change for the safety of the Tour Party)

Encourage tour parties to depart the chalet at different times to avoid unintentional mixing of tour groups.

In the event of a late or missing person incident the Chalet should not be left unattended. If the Chalet is unattended, tour groups should return to the Chalet as soon as is safe to do so.

Situation 1:

Tour Parties are late to return but have been in contact with the Chalet to update progress.



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- Update return information and route on the Tours Trip Intention Form.
- No consumption of alcohol until Tour Parties return.
- If it has been snowing, consider sending a group (of at least 4) out to set ski trails in the direction they are returning from if it is safe to do so. Ski for 1/2 hour then return.
- Continue with 'Chalet Life' as normal.
- At dusk or in poor weather, turn on outside lights to guide Tour Party in.
- Ensure there is hot water for showers, and hot drinks for the Tour Party on their return.
- Once the group is back safe, fed and rested, Nobs and tour group should conduct a review of the tour.
- Consider completing an incident report,

Situation 2: Tour Groups are late and have not made contact.

- Allow ½ hour from intended return time before attempting to contact.
 - Attempt telephone contact via phone with all Tour Party members
 - Attempt Radio contact from Chalet, then Tow Hut (greater range)
 - Attempt SMS messaging – text may get through where voice cannot.
 - Attempt contact by these means every 15 minutes until contact is established.
 - Once contact is established, if assistance is not required revert to 'Situation 1 – In Contact guidelines.
- Consider reasons for delay and no contact
 - Poor weather may slow the Tour Party and effect reception
 - Tour location may have poor reception.
- No Contact after 1 hour
 - Contact the Wardens
 - Have trip intentions form on hand.
 - Follow the advice of the Wardens
- No consumption of alcohol until Tour Party returns.
- If it has been snowing, consider sending a group (of at least 4) out to set ski trails in the direction they are returning from if safe to do so. Ski for 1/2 hour then return.
- Continue with 'Chalet Life' as normal (no alcohol – Chalet may need to provide assistance).
- At dusk turn on outside lights to guide group in.
- Ensure there is hot water for showers, and hot drinks for the Tour Party on their return.
- Once the group is back safe, fed and rested, Nobs and tour group should conduct a review of the tour.
- Complete an incident report

Situation 3: If a Tour Party Requires Assistance

- If urgent medical assistance is required, the Tour Party must contact 000!
- Communicate location using Latitude and Longitude (Emergency Plus app)
- Notify Wardens and follow their advice.



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- Record Time, Location Situation and Action Trip Intentions form
- Consider if the Winter Party members are the best option to assist.
- Once the Tour Party is evacuated or back safe, fed and rested, Nobs and tour group should conduct a review of the tour.
- Complete an incident report

Situation 4: Individual Members of the Touring Party Missing (Lost someone)

- Consider the safety of the entire Touring Party before taking action.
- Attempt contact by Phone or Radio
- Determine the likely Food, water clothing and equipment carried by the missing person(s)
- Communicate situation to Chalet/Nobs/Warden as soon as practical. (Check the person is not at the Chalet or on another tour)
- Consider if the Winter Party members are the best option to assist.
- Retrace route to missing person's last known location if safe to do so.
 - Conduct a *Hasty Search* – send groups out and back on tracks from their last known location, no more than 1 hour out and back. Search for the amount of time they have been missing.
- Communicate situation to Chalet/Nobs/Warden
 - The missing person is located – contact the Chalet/Nobs/Warden
 - The missing person cannot be located - contact 000, Warden, Nobs, Chalet
- Make noise (blow whistles, call out) at regular intervals and listen for missing person's calls/whistle.
- Once the Tour Party is back safe, fed and rested, Nobs and tour group should conduct a review of the tour.
- Complete an incident report

Situation 5: Missing Person from the Chalet (not on tour)

- Ask all participants if they know the persons current or most recent whereabouts/intentions. Consider ringing the bell to get attention and gather everyone.
- Check with any Tour Parties out if the person is with them.
- Check whiteboard – send out a party of 4 of capable participants to check last known location if close to the chalet.
- Execute a thorough room by room search of the Chalet, including emergency shelter.
- Execute a search of immediate area outside the Chalet, check Tow Hut, igloos, piles of snow fallen from roofs. (groups of 4)
- Confirm their ski gear and personal equipment are at the chalet.
- If you cannot locate them, contact the Wardens and follow their advice.
- Once the member is located and safe, Nobs and party member should conduct a review of the situation.
- Consider completing an incident report



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Guidelines for Wardens and Nobs:

- Have Party/Chalet call 000 if immediate specialist outside assistance is required (urgent medical, search and rescue, urgent evacuation) – request a callback after this has been done.
- Get as much information about the situation to make an informed decision:
 - Location/Route
 - Participants – number, names and experience
 - Current observed weather conditions
 - Current Snow conditions – patchy, fresh, icy, deep
 - What food and Equipment the Tour Party has
 - Injuries or possible health conditions
 - What action has been taken so far.
- Consider the following when deciding a course of action.
 - Weather and Snow surface conditions
 - Location/Terrain
 - Skill and Experience
 - Equipment
- The Wardens will decide if the Party is to attempt a greeting party or Search and Rescue attempt.
- Once Chalet knows their course of action:
 - Call Scout Help Line if:
 - 000 has been called
 - Parent/Emergency Contacts need to be notified
 - Outside assistance is required
 - Off mountain accommodation needs to be arranged
 - Counselling or Chaplaincy is required
- Follow up with required Scouts Victoria incident reporting

Approved by Risk Sub-Group 13th April 2025

Ratified: 16th April 2025

To be reviewed: No later than March 2028